



AI workflow readiness.

Seven questions to decide whether one repeated job is ready for a working AI-assisted system.

USE THIS BEFORE YOU BUY A TOOL

Choose the work. Name the owner. Keep the judgment.

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AI Creator / Trainer / Workflow Builder

BUILD THE WORKFLOW. KEEP THE JUDGMENT.

FIRST MOVE

Choose one job, not a department.

Readiness is specific. Score one repeated job at a time. If the job is too broad to describe in one sentence, narrow it before you score it.

TOO BROAD

Use AI in operations.

No clear trigger, owner, input, or finish line.

READY TO SCORE

Turn an approved meeting transcript into a reviewed client recap.

One job. One output. One named review point.

NAME YOUR JOB

When this happens...

One owner needs to...

Using this input...

And the job is done when...

THE FOUR-PART METHOD



FIND THE WORK



BOUND THE AI JOB



KEEP THE HUMAN CHECK



DOCUMENT NEXT USE

FOUNDATION

Does the work deserve a system?

A workflow install needs a repeatable job and one accountable owner. Without both, the project is still an experiment.

01

REPEATED JOB

Does the same job happen often enough to justify a system?

Automating a rare or constantly changing task creates more maintenance than value.

EVIDENCE TO LOOK FOR

List the last five runs. The trigger and core steps should look recognizably similar.

☐ Yes☐ Not yet

02

ACCOUNTABLE OWNER

Is one person responsible for the outcome and able to approve change?

A committee can advise. One owner must decide what works, what fails, and what ships.

EVIDENCE TO LOOK FOR

Write one name and one decision they own. If you need a list of names, this is not ready.

☐ Yes☐ Not yet

BOUNDARIES

Can you see the start and the finish?

Good workflows have a stable trigger, a usable input, and an observable finish line. If those move every time, the system cannot be tested honestly.

03

STABLE INPUT

Does the job begin with an input you can name, access, and inspect?

The system needs a dependable starting point, not details scattered across memory, messages, and tabs.

EVIDENCE TO LOOK FOR

Name the trigger and input: a form, approved transcript, report, request, or structured file.

☐ Yes☐ Not yet

04

CLEAR FINISH LINE

Can two people agree on what done means?

Speed is useless when no one can tell whether the output is complete, correct, and ready to use.

EVIDENCE TO LOOK FOR

Write the observable result, required fields, format, destination, and unacceptable misses.

☐ Yes☐ Not yet

PROOF

Who checks it, and how will you test?

The AI can accelerate a draft or route. A person remains accountable for facts, exceptions, judgment, and the final decision.

05

HUMAN APPROVAL

Is a named person responsible for reviewing the result before it matters?

A useful workflow makes the human check explicit. It does not hide responsibility behind the tool.

EVIDENCE TO LOOK FOR

Name the reviewer, what they verify, the exceptions they own, and the final action they approve.

☐ Yes☐ Not yet

06

REPRESENTATIVE TESTS

Do you have ten real examples that represent normal work and edge cases?

A polished demo proves one path. A test set reveals whether the workflow survives actual variation.

EVIDENCE TO LOOK FOR

Collect normal, incomplete, unusual, high-risk, and unacceptable cases. Remove restricted data first.

☐ Yes☐ Not yet

GUARDRAIL

Can you test it in a safe, owned path?

A workflow is not ready when its first version depends on data, access, or tools your organization has not approved.

07

SAFE DATA AND CLIENT-OWNED TOOLS

Can you build and test with permitted data inside a path the client controls?

Evidence: list the approved tools, access owner, data class, retention rule, and a safe rollback path.

☐ Yes☐ Not yet

STOP SIGNS

- **Restricted data** Sensitive, regulated, client, patient, or employee data has no approved test path.
- **Hidden access** The workflow needs shared passwords, personal accounts, or credentials with no named owner.
- **No recovery** There is no manual fallback, version history, or clear way to undo a bad run.

This guide is educational, not legal, privacy, security, or compliance advice. Follow your organization's policies and verify tool terms before using real data.

SCORECARD

Count evidence, not enthusiasm.

Give one point only when you can name the evidence. A confident guess is still not yet. The score tells you the next move, not whether the idea is good.

#	CHECK	EVIDENCE	YES	NOT YET
01	Repeated job	Last five runs look similar	☐	☐
02	Accountable owner	One name, one decision	☐	☐
03	Stable input	Trigger and input are named	☐	☐
04	Clear finish line	Done and failure are observable	☐	☐
05	Human approval	Reviewer and check are explicit	☐	☐
06	Representative tests	Ten varied cases are ready	☐	☐
07	Safe owned path	Approved data, tools, and rollback	☐	☐

TOTAL _____ / 7

6-7**READY FOR FIT**

Only if 05 and 07 are Yes. Then take the full check and send a Project Fit brief.

3-5**FIX THE GAPS**

Choose the weakest condition. Observe five more runs, then score again.

0-2**KEEP IT MANUAL**

Narrow the job and document the current path before adding AI.

ONE-PAGE BRIEF

Turn your score into a buildable brief.

Use this after a six or seven only when checks 05 and 07 are Yes. It is the useful starting point for Project Fit and exposes the exact gap when the job is not ready.

JOB

What repeated job are we changing?

OWNER

Who owns the outcome and approves change?

TRIGGER + INPUT

What starts the job, and what material enters the system?

FINISH LINE

What does done look like, and what counts as failure?

HUMAN CHECK

Who reviews what before the result is used?

TEST SET

Which ten cases represent normal work and edge conditions?

BOUNDARIES

Which tools, data, access, retention, and rollback rules apply?

READY?

Open the online readiness check and send the brief when the evidence is real.

ONE REPEATED JOB

One working system. One documented handoff.

The AI Workflow Install Sprint turns one qualified repeated job into a tested system inside a client-owned path. Human approval stays at the decision point.

TAKE THE READINESS CHECK

<https://www.keithstagers.com/workflow-readiness/>

ALREADY HAVE THE EVIDENCE?

Send a qualified Project Fit brief.

<https://www.keithstagers.com/project-fit/>

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